

KEYBOARDS

We tested 11 keyboards that also included a few cordless ones.

Build quality

As far as build quality is concerned, the Samsung SDL1500 feels great. The keys can withstand a lot of beating even after prolonged usage. The noise level is minimal, and the buttons give a good feel while typing. The keys do not attract much dust either. The base of the keyboard grips the desk very nicely. The Acer Acufeel keyboard also can withstand a lot of rough use without complaining. The build quality of the keyboard is excellent and has extra protection to protect the membrane, which has the circuit etched on it, from direct contact from dust and liquid. The keys feel smooth while typing and make very low noise. The Logitech cordless freedom navigator is also a good choice for people who enjoy good build quality. This keyboard feels good-n-chunky and the noise while typing is almost nil.

Performance

The quality of keystrokes is an important characteristic. A good keyboard has a nice feel to it while you type on it—the keys get pressed smoothly and you don't have to bang on them. And of course, it doesn't make a loud racket when you type.

You can work faster if the shortcut keys are placed so that they can be executed faster. So if you want a keyboard that performs well, look for the smoothness and placement of important keys and shortcut keys.

We found the **Logitech Cordless Freedom Navigator**, a mouse-and-keyboard combo, very good where it came to performance. The normal keys are well laid out and so are the shortcut keys. The feel of the keyboard while typing is very good. The keyboard feels comfortable while typing and the palm rest can be detached if you want more desktop space. The soft touch side panels offer a comfortable grip while the device is being used. The Maple Internet Media keyboard too has a good layout of keys and the device includes an e-mail indicator. It has a standard keyboard layout with eight exclusive function keys, plus 15 dual function Intelli-keys for multimedia, Internet and programmable functions.

Features

Most of the keyboards that we tested were feature-rich, but the ones that really stood

Microsoft Internet Keyboard



out were the Microsoft Internet Keyboard Pro, Logitech Deluxe 104 and the Logitech cordless freedom navigator. The Microsoft Internet Keyboard Pro offers 19 time saving hot keys and a pair of USB ports. It features two USB ports that allow

users to easily plug USB devices, such as scanners and game controllers, directly into the keyboard, eliminating the need to reach behind the PC to swap peripherals. Internet hot keys allow users with Internet

Samsung SDL1500:
Value for your money



access to launch a browser and surf the Web directly from the keyboard. There are Internet, e-mail and multimedia hot-keys. In the Logitech Cordless Freedom Navigator there are three sets of small, rubberised keys to access/control your CD/DVD playback, open your browser, and put your PC into standby mode. The Logitech system works on radio frequencies, therefore it is non-directional. This saves you from the worry of pointing the device at the sensor in order to use it. Logitech has included an automatic 'sleep mode' feature to preserve battery power while the units aren't in active use.

Value for money

The **Samsung SDL1500** gives you great value for money because though the keyboard does not include features that are found in the high-end keyboards, it still provides you with the normal features that a SoHo user would require. The same goes for the Acer Acufeel, which is also very competitively priced and is a great choice for the value-minded consumer. Logitech deluxe 104 provides you with one-touch Internet access and a space-saving design. The keys feel very comfortable. The gently curved palm rest provides adequate wrist support and can be detached for extra desk space. The Logitech Deluxe 104 keyboard is one of the very economical keyboards around.

SCORE BOARD Specifications

Stroking the Keys							
Manufacturer	Model name	Interface	Contact	E-mail	Phone	Price (Rs)	Rating
Acer	Acufeel	PS/2	Micro Masters	farr@bom.vsnl.net.in	022-3880597	300	B
Logitech	Cordless Freedom Navigator	USB	Rashi Peripherals	ho@rptechindia.com	022-8260258	7,750	A-
Logitech	Deluxe 104	PS/2	Rashi Peripherals	ho@rptechindia.com	022-8260258	600	B
Maple	Internet media keyboard [MCK 2000]	PS/2	Selathaar Industries	marketing@maple.cu.in	044-8252275	775	B-
Maple	Internet multimedia keyboard [MCK 800]	PS/2	Selathaar Industries	marketing@maple.cu.in	044-8252275	1,100	B-
Maple	Multimedia keyboard Pro [EKB 804]	PS/2	Selathaar Industries	marketing@maple.cu.in	044-8252275	1,800	B
Maple	Universal keyboard [MCK 500]	PS/2	Selathaar Industries	marketing@maple.cu.in	044-8252275	475	B-
Maple	Eagletouch [MCK 800 01]	PS/2	Selathaar Industries	marketing@maple.cu.in	044-8252275	1,500	B
Microsoft	Internet keyboard pro	USB	Mnemonic Systems	mnemonic@vsnl.com	022-8010871	3,000	B
Samsung	sdl1500	PS/2	Micro Masters	farr@bom.vsnl.net.in	022-3880597	500	B+
Typhoon	Slim Internet keyboard	PS/2	Hitech computers	bom@hitechit.com	022-4914642	900	B-